



« I always emphasise that you should be prepared to fail because if you're not ready for that possibility, you've already set yourself up for failure »

DEANDRA DOTTIN

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Long before she became a superstar in women's cricket, Deandra Dottin excelled in athletics, winning medals for Barbados in the CARIFTA Games — the annual athletics competition established by the Caribbean Free Trade Association.

A prominent javelin thrower who also participated in the shot put, Dottin embraces her self-proclaimed nickname 'World Boss,' which motivates her to deliver stellar performances, particularly on the cricket pitch.

Dottin, a veteran of 146 Women's ODIs and 135 T20Is, was the first woman to score a T20I century, achieving the feat in just 38 balls against South Africa during the 2010 Women's T20 World Cup — a record that remains unbeaten.

On the recent West Indies tour of India, Dottin showcased flashes of brilliance despite her team losing both the T20I and ODI series.

Her visit to India also marked a major career highlight, as she was

bought by Gujarat Giants for Rs 1.70 crore, making her the most expensive overseas player in this year's Women's Premier League (WPL) auction.

Dottin's WPL journey has been eventful — she was controversially released by Gujarat in the inaugural season, went unsold last year, but attracted a fierce bidding war this time. Gujarat eventually re-acquired her services.

Speaking to *Sportstar* in Vadodara, Dottin reflected on her journey, her return from retirement, and the road ahead.

You've recently come out of retirement to resume your international career with the West Indies. What has the experience been like for you so far?

The journey has been really good. I have been doing a lot of work behind the scenes, even before I came back, so that as soon as I hit the ground running, it would be a lot easier for me. I would be able to

produce what I am accustomed to producing.

What led to your sudden retirement in 2022? Do you have any regrets about having made that decision?

I really don't talk about it, but what happened in the past and the decision I made back then have had a great impact on my cricket now. It was a really good choice at the time because I've learnt a lot. I've been able to catch up on many things and realise things I thought weren't a problem, which actually were. So, that break actually did something for me.

Would you say it was an emotional call?

I do not think so. I think everything happens for a reason. If it was not supposed to happen that way, then it would not have. You live and you learn. Things do happen. It is just how you pick up and go about it.